International Economic Development Council (IEDC) Capstone Project

Project Title: *Understanding Barriers to Sustainability Adoption for Arizona Organizations;* examining the barriers Arizona small businesses, non-profits, and other local organizations face in adopting cost-saving, sustainable practices.

Team Members:

- Tyler Butler, Collaboration for Good
- Amanda Jordan, City of Phoenix
- Jeanine Jerkovic, City of Surprise

Interview Questions

1. What sustainability-related tools, services or programs (if any) have your clients or your own organization already used or explored?

We've worked with other organizations to make our events zero waste, including GreenLight Solutions for bin guarding, local municipalities for recycling services and education, Sedona Recycles, Compost Crowd, R. City, ASU's Rob and Melani Walton Sustainability Solutions Service (for hard-to-recycle plastics), and Bold Reuse.

2. What have been the biggest challenges or barriers to using these tools, services or programs? From your organizational perspective as well as your clients' perspective.

The cost is always a barrier, especially for reuse services. We seek out sponsors to cover those costs. Additionally, with such a small team (one part-time coordinator who runs the organization and one VERY part-time marketing assistant), we have limited time to seek out sponsorships and identify relevant tools/organizations to take advantage of in addition to our other responsibilities.

3. What kind of support do your clients typically request and how often does sustainability come up as a requested tool/strategy if at all?

Circular Arizona members regularly ask for recommendations for recycling less common items or for help connecting with a particular service, which we're happy to do as a "connector" organization, to the extent that we are aware of services and offerings in the area they serve.

4. How familiar or comfortable are you with suggesting sustainability solutions?

We are relatively comfortable with this as a sustainability nonprofit :)

5. How aware are you and/or your clients of the sustainability tools available at the federal, state, and local levels?

We are definitely aware of state-level education and grant resources, somewhat at the federal level, and moreso at the local level for more involved municipalities and tribes.

6. How likely would you or your clients be to utilize a sustainability tool/solution if it was easily accessible and free or low cost?

Free or low cost would be amazing, and I'm sure our members would love to take advantage of something like that!

7. Would you be interested in future engagement and report of findings?

Yes please!